

CURRICULUM VITAE

FRANCISCO GAZITUA COSTABAL

www.franciscogazitua.com

Francisco Gazitua Costabal was born in Santiago, Chile, in September 1944.
He lives and works at his studio-quarry in San Juan de Pirque, at the foot of
Chile's Central Andes.

NATIONAL ARTS PRIZE - VISUAL ARTS

Republic of Chile - 2021

EDUCATION, TRAINING AND STUDIES

IN CHILE

He learned wood carving and wrought-iron work from childhood with his uncle and mentor Luis Costabal Echenique. He completed his primary and secondary education at Colegio de los Sagrados Corazones in Santiago, Chile.

PONTIFICAL CATHOLIC UNIVERSITY: From 1963 to 1966 he pursued undergraduate studies in Philosophy. In 1964 he also attended drawing courses at the Instituto Cultural de Las Condes with Professor Claudio Di Girolamo.

UNIVERSITY OF CHILE: Nine years of training in workshops and academic courses. In 1965 he joined the workshop of sculptor Sergio Castillo Mandiola. From 1966 to 1970 he studied Sculpture at the Faculty of Fine Arts, University of Chile, under Lily Garafulic, Marta Colvin, Abraham Freifeld, Alberto Perez, Gracia Barrios, Ivan Vial, Carlos Ortuzar, Pedro Miras, Claudio Duran, Reinaldo Villasenor and Luis Advis. In 1974 he worked in the studio of sculptor Samuel Roman Rojas.

ABROAD

In 1977 and 1978 he completed postgraduate studies in Sculpture at St Martin's School of Art in London, under the guidance of Sir Anthony Caro, Philip King and Tim Scott. During 1978-1979 he worked in England as an assistant to Tim Scott and Philip King. In 1980 he took part in a cycle of studio visits and conversations with Henry Moore, guided by artist Michel Muller at Moore's studio in Much Hadham, United Kingdom. In 1991 he joined a cycle of conversations with sculptor Eduardo Chillida Juantegui at Chillida-Leku in San Sebastian, Basque Country, led by sculptor Carlos Lizasoain.

In 1991 he obtained a Bachelor of Fine Arts, majoring in Sculpture, from the School of Arts at the Pontifical Catholic University of Chile, graduating with highest distinction.

TEACHING

He has taught sculpture at a wide range of institutions:

1968	School of Arts, Pontifical Catholic University of Chile, in Wilma Hanning's chair.
1969-1973	UNIVERSITY OF CHILE, School of Fine Arts: teaching assistant in Marta Colvin's chair; sculpture instructor at the El Teniente mining complex Cultural Center, under an agreement between the Faculty of Fine Arts, University of Chile, and Sociedad Minera El Teniente.
1978-1985	Professor for seven years in the Sculpture Department at St Martin's School of Art, London, then the world's most prestigious center for the discipline. The quality of his work led to his inclusion in the New Generation of British Sculptors. He taught postgraduate groups investigating new expressive possibilities in Constructed Sculpture and mixed media.
<i>"Saint Martin's School of Art... Frank Martin became head of the sculpture department... he brought in young sculptors and recent graduates of the department as teachers. Among these, Anthony Caro was particularly influential. The group around him came to be known as the 'New Generation of British sculptors' and the sculpture department of Saint Martin's became, in the words of Tim Scott, 'the most famous in the art world.'" Bruce McLean, The Guardian, 2 March 2004; accessed August 2013.</i>	
1981-2026	Founding professor and permanent faculty member for forty years at the Kornarija Marble Sculpture School, Istria, Croatia. The school was founded through an agreement between the British Council, St Martin's School of Art and the Yugoslav Cultural Council; it is now linked to the Famul Stuart School of Arts in Slovenia.
1983-1985	Professor of Sculpture at St Martin's School of Art, London, and sculpture professor at City Lit School of Arts, London.
1984	Visiting professor at the Royal College of Art, London, United Kingdom.
1990-1992	Professor of Sculpture, School of Art, Pontifical Catholic University of Chile.
1990-1994	Professor of Stone Arts at the Escuela Taller, Parque de los Reyes, Santiago.
1992	Professor at Atelier Livre, Porto Alegre, Brazil.
1996-2000	Founding professor of the Sculpture program at Universidad Finis Terrae, Santiago, Chile.
2000-2018	Visiting professor, Universidad Finis Terrae, Santiago, Chile.
2006-2011	Professor-Master at meetings of the British Artist Blacksmiths Association (BABA), Ironbridge, United Kingdom.
2014	Professor-Master for the Artist-Blacksmith's Association of North America, Delaware, United States.

2015	Professor-Master at the International Artist Blacksmith Convention, Monaghan, Ireland.
2017	Professor-Master for the British Artist Blacksmiths Association (BABA). Participated in the construction of the British First World War Memorial in Ypres, Belgium. Seminar professor in sculpture at Hereford College of Arts, West Midlands, England.
2019	Professor in the Sculpture Seminar, University of Guadalajara, Guadalajara, Mexico.
2022	Sculpture seminar at Hampstead School of Art, London.

After forty years of university teaching, he continues to teach postgraduate students from Chile and other countries in his Pirque studio, referred by fellow professors from universities around the world. His teaching also extends to workshops and symposia that he organizes or attends in Chile and abroad. Many young sculptors from Chile, Latin America, Europe and North America have benefited from his instruction.

SYMPOSIA AND WORKSHOPS

He has organized and actively participated in international sculpture symposia and workshops:

ABROAD

1983	Oxford Sculpture Project, England. Curated by David Elliott, Director of the Museum of Modern Art, Oxford.
1985-1989	Kornarija, Croatia. Curated by Francisco Gazitua for the British Council.
1989	Forma Viva, Portoroz, Yugoslavia. Curated by Tony Biloslav, Slovenia.
1990	Venezuela: Symposium on Education for the Visual Arts of Ibero-America and the Caribbean, UNESCO. Directed by Teresa Wagner, Senior Programme Specialist at UNESCO.
1992	Berlin Stahl Workshop, Germany. Curators: Professor Tim Scott and Robert Kudielka, Akademie der Kunste, Berlin.
1994	Atelier Livre, Porto Alegre, Brazil, curated by Professor Maria Amelia Bulhoes; Sculpture Symposium, Resistencia, Chaco, Argentina.
1995	International Ice Sculpture Symposium, Milwaukee, Wisconsin, United States.
1996	First Wood Sculpture Symposium, Alajuela, Costa Rica.
1997	International Sculpture Symposium, Rachana, Lebanon.
1999	International Direct-Concrete Sculpture Symposium, Parque Los Colomos, Guadalajara, Mexico.
2000	International Steel Sculpture Symposium, curated by the Faculty of Fine Arts, University of Guadalajara, Mexico.
2002	Art Below Sea Level Symposium, Kinderdijk, Netherlands.
2005	Seattle, United States: Master at the world symposium of the Artist-Blacksmith's Association of North America.
2006	Jury member at the Chaco Biennial, Argentina; British Artist Blacksmiths Association meeting, Ironbridge, England.
2009	The Strategy of Form, Museum of Contemporary Art (MARCO), Monterrey, Mexico. Curated by Nina Zambrano, Lily Kassner, Karen Wilkin and Sir Anthony Caro.
2011	Professor-Master at the International Artist Blacksmith Symposium, Monaghan, Ireland.

2014	Master at the Artist-Blacksmith's Association of North America.
2016	Ypres, Belgium: symposium for the construction of the British memorial commemorating the centenary of the First World War.
IN CHILE	
1986	Patio de America, Catholic University campus in Maule, Talca. Curated by the Catholic University of Talca, Rector Hernan Correa and Francisco Gazitua.
1988	Isla Negra, Homage to Pablo Neruda. Organized by the Pablo Neruda Foundation, British Council and the Cultural Office of Spain; organizers Carlos Lizariturry and Francisco Gazitua.
1989	CAP Sculptures, Parque Forestal, Santiago.
1990	Steel in Sculpture, Amigos del Arte, Santiago.
1991	Ferro-Sculptures, Maestranza San Eugenio, Santiago. Curated by the National Museum of Fine Arts of Chile, Nemesio Antunez and Francisco Gazitua.
1992	First Ibero-American UNESCO Symposium. Curated by Teresa Wagner, Senior Programme Specialist at UNESCO, and Francisco Gazitua. Participating sculptors included Sebastian, Hernan Dompe, Jose Villa Soberon, Carlos Lizariturry, Irineu Garcia, Costas Koulentianos, Gail Morris, Carlos Medina, Felix Maruenda, Jaime Antunez, Gaspar Galaz, Osvaldo Pena, Ximena Rodriguez, Marcela Correa, Paulo Ribera, Yesica Torres, Alfredo Fernandez and Francisco Gazitua. Theorists included Maria Amelia Bulhoes, Alberto Perez, Nelly Richard, Justo Pastor Mellado and Pedro Labowitz. Sponsors included UNESCO, the National Museum of Fine Arts, the Ministry of Education and the Municipality of Santiago.
1994	Joined a cultural embassy to Antarctica and created a monumental sculpture on an iceberg. After a fifteen-day stay in November, he received the traditional Antarctic baptism.
1997	First International Marble Sculpture Symposium, Ciudad Empresarial, Huechuraba, Santiago.
2000	Second International Steel Sculpture Symposium, Ciudad Empresarial, Huechuraba, Santiago.
2003	Fourth International Stone Sculpture Symposium - Granite, Ciudad Empresarial, Huechuraba, Santiago.
2004	Fifth Concrete Sculpture Symposium, Ciudad Empresarial, Huechuraba, Santiago.
2014-2021	Created and developed the project Reconstruction of Apachetas in the Central Andes of Chile, rebuilding ancestral stone markers along Andean trails.

2016-2019

Participated in the four Our Parks symposia, Santiago.

MONUMENTAL SCULPTURES

Fifty-seven large-scale sculptures are installed in public spaces and sites in Chile and other countries:

1968	San Jorge, iron, 3.5 x 2 x 1.5 m, Santa Ana, Talagante, Chile.
1970	Virgen del templo: Yo sostengo tu cruz, wood, 2.30 m, Benedictine Monastery, Las Condes, Santiago, Chile. Joint creation by Francisco Gazitua, Marta Colvin and monk-architect Martin Correa.
1979	Marble sculpture at Forma Viva, Portoroz, Slovenia. Curated by Tony Biloslav.
1980-1983	Marusici 1 and Marusici 2, marble sculptures, Kornarija, Marusici, Croatia.
1982	Marta-Carmen, stone, Cherwell Upper School, Oxford, England. Curated by David Elliott, Director of the Museum of Modern Art, Oxford, and Oxford City Council.
1986	Stone sculpture, Patio de America, Catholic University, Maule, Talca, Chile.
1987	Steel sculpture, Parque Forestal, Santiago, for CAP S.A.
1988	Granite sculpture, Pablo Neruda Foundation, Isla Negra, Chile; steel and stone sculpture, Fincard, Santiago, Chile.
1990	Sculptural doors in granite and wrought iron for the Senate and Chamber of Deputies, National Congress, Valparaíso, Chile; Sagrada Familia, monumental wood sculpture, Cala Cala, Cochabamba, Bolivia.
1991	Ferro-Sculpture symposium work, Maestranza San Eugenio, Santiago; Un Banco para el Banco, stone, Security Decora, Santiago; stone and steel sculpture, Sigdo Koppers building, Santiago.
1992	Gabriela Mistral, stone, Parque Americo Vespucio, Las Condes, Santiago; Memorial at the General Cemetery of Santiago, comprising a sculptural wall and four sculptures; forged-steel sculpture, IPAC, Cerrillos, Santiago.
1994	Monumental sculpture on an iceberg in the Drake Sea, Antarctica; large ice sculpture in a public square in Milwaukee, Wisconsin.
1995	Steel sculpture, Sauce del Maule, University of Talca; granite sculpture, Alameda, Rancagua; monumental steel sculpture, Santiago International Airport.
1996	Hito, monumental granite sculpture, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago; Mesa de las Materias, educational sculpture, National Museum of Fine Arts collection; Fuente Claudio Arrau, monumental steel sculpture, Chillan; steel sculpture, Ciudad Empresarial, Huechuraba; two granite sculptures donated to Ciudad Abierta-Ritoque, Valparaíso.

1997	Fuente montañas de Chile, stone, Santiago Marriott Hotel; stone and copper sculpture, Radomiro Tomic Mine, Calama; Arquero, steel, Avenida El Bosque, Santiago; Almendra del Libano, marble, Rachana, Lebanon; stone sculpture, Ericsson Building, Santiago.
1998-2000	Rueda de Larmahue, steel, Museo Interactivo Mirador, Santiago; Fuente para los jóvenes, granite sculptural complex, Plaza Pedro de Valdivia, Providencia; wood sculpture, Banco Nacional Collection, Alajuela, Costa Rica; Moldes para el Ferrocarril, sculptural mural, Museo Interactivo Mirador, Santiago.
2000	Monumental concrete sculpture, Parque Los Colomos, Guadalajara, Mexico; Puente hacia Kiev, steel, Los Heroes Metro Station, Santiago.
2001	Cordillera de Los Andes-Anderna, Humlegarden Park, Stockholm, Sweden; Buque Esmeralda II, steel, Las Condes, Santiago; Homenaje a Emerson, granite, Americo Vespucio median strip, Las Condes; Caballo de Guadalajara, steel, University of Guadalajara, Mexico.
2002	Caballos de Los Angeles, two steel sculptures, Los Angeles, Biobio Region, Chile.
2003	El Bebedor de los Vientos, steel, Vina Anakena, Requinoa, Chile.
2004	Aeropuerto Version II, steel, Santiago International Airport; Piedra de cuatro miradas, granite, Sculpture Park bridge, Providencia, Santiago.
2005	Barca Volante, steel, Concord CityPlace, Toronto, Canada, selected through an international juried competition.
2006	Flauta Precolombina, granite, University of Talca; Artstairs, steel and granite, Concord CityPlace, Toronto; Art-table, stone, 4.5 x 1.5 x 0.70 m, Toronto.
2007	Rosa Nautica, Concord CityPlace, Toronto; Lengas de acero, two steel sculptures, Avenida Apoquindo, Santiago.
2008	Pillar of Friendship, Liverpool, England.
2009	Art Canopy, steel, The Esplanade, Toronto; steel and stone sculpture donated to Espacio Matta Cultural Center, La Granja, Santiago.
2010	Pluma para Gabriela Mistral, steel and stone, Paseo La Pastora, Las Condes; Rueda, University of the Andes, Santiago; Monarch, ensemble of six steel and stone sculptures, Liberty Village, Toronto.
2011	Absolut, sculptural ensemble, Mississauga, Canada.
2012	Perpetual Motion, Liberty Village, Toronto; Monument to Fray Francisco Valdes Subercaseaux, Pucon, Chile.

2010-2013	Puente de Luz, Concord CityPlace, Toronto: a walkable sculpture measuring 100 x 5 x 5 m, crossed annually by three million people and now an international reference in the relationship between architecture, engineering and sculpture.
2013	Split Rock Gap, Liberty Village, Toronto; Reconnecting with the ARC, sculptural installation in nature, Maldonado, Uruguay.
2014	Caballo de Lo Barnechea, Santiago; Arte de Pajaros, School of Engineering, University of Chile; Piedra filosofal, San Joaquín Campus, Pontifical Catholic University; Sol de piedra, granite, El Tranque Cultural Center, Lo Barnechea.
2015	Puertas de Chicureo, sculptural ensemble, Santiago; Black & Knight, sculptural ensemble, Calgary, Canada; Mesa Jardinera, granite, Huelquen, Paine; six Caupolican sculptures for the University of Talca's Maule Museum collection, involving the modeling and casting process of Nicanor Plaza's original figure.
2016	Pirca para Jackson Hole, Wyoming, United States; Buque de Los Vilos, Los Vilos, Coquimbo Region; reinstallation of Caleuche, Austral University of Chile, Puerto Montt.
2017	Rueda del Maule, University of Talca; sculptural benches, Baha'i Temple, Penalolén, Santiago, curated by Hariri Pontarini Architects.
2018	Andes High Cross, Kilmore, Scotland, United Kingdom; ensemble of sculptural fountains and tables, Francisco Selame House, Santiago.
2019	Vigia de la Luna, granite, Lo Curro, Santiago; Doble Rueda and Mesa-Agua, Arturo Lopez Perez Foundation, Providencia; Beduino, steel sculptural vessel, Cofradía Nautica, Algarrobo.
2020	Cruz Mateo 25, tribute to Father Mariano Puga and the 50th anniversary of the University Parish, Santa Ana Church, Santiago; Circunnavegación, monument commemorating the 500th anniversary of Magellan's voyage, Punta Arenas.
2021	Puente Crepusculario, accessible walkable bridge-sculpture for people with disabilities, TACAL Foundation, Independencia district, western Santiago.
2022	Monumental Portal and Sculptural Staircase, Casa Tres Volcanes, Villarrica; Andes Wheel, Hampstead Manor Sculpture Garden, London; Homage to the Arts and Sciences, Pontifical Catholic University, San Joaquín Campus.
2023	Circumnavigation, Kilmore, Scotland; Pluma de siete colores, Villa Olímpica, Maipú, Santiago; 22 Instrumentos primordiales, Vina El Cruceral, Píruque; Caballo Alazan, Parque Cuenca Andina de Los Quenes.
2024	Caballo de Ricardo Walker, Panguipulli, Chile.
2025	Caballo Palmas de Penaflor, Río Claro; Caballo Pircano, Píruque; Cruz del Sur, University of Aysén, Coyhaique.

2026

La pluma es mas poderosa que la espada, Vitacura, Santiago.

MAJOR EXHIBITIONS

IN CHILE

1968-1969	Student Salons, Faculty of Fine Arts, University of Chile.
1977	New Values in Chilean Painting and Sculpture, Instituto Cultural de Las Condes, Santiago; solo exhibition Sculpture and Drawing, Chilean-British Institute of Culture, Santiago.
1986	Parque Forestal Exhibition, CAP Competition, Santiago.
1989	Solo exhibition Sculptures from the Body, Galeria Plastica Nueva, Santiago.
1993	Solo exhibition, Sculpture Park, Santiago.
1995	Solo exhibition, National Museum of Fine Arts, Santiago; solo exhibition, University of Talca.
1996	Group exhibition Stone in Sculpture, CTC Building, Santiago.
2000	Solo exhibition Stone, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago; Sculptures 2000, Americo Vespucio median strip, Santiago; solo exhibition Steel Vessels, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago.
2001	The Spiral of Life, Fundacion Telefonica Hall, Santiago; Sculpture in the Square, Plaza de Armas, Santiago; What We Are, University of Concepcion, University of Talca and Pontifical Catholic University Extension Center.
2003	Solo exhibition Steel Horses, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago. Awarded the Chilean Art Critics Circle Prize.
2006	Solo exhibition Tierra del Fuego: Trees without Shadow, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago.
2008	Solo exhibition, Bodegon Cultural de Los Vilos, Coquimbo Region.
2009	Solo exhibition Black and White, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago. Awarded the Chilean Art Critics Circle Prize.
2012	Solo exhibition Sculptural Bridges, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago.
2015	Solo exhibition Journey to the Heart of Stone, Galeria Artespacio, Santiago.
2017	Family of Artists in the Maipo Valley, Museo Andino, group exhibition with Teresa Gazitua, Carmen Gazitua, Francisco Gazitua, Enrique Rodriguez and Angela Leible.

2017-2018	Body and Matter, group sculpture exhibition, Sala Gasco, Santiago.
2018	Solo exhibition Primordial Sculptural Objects, Universidad San Sebastian, Santiago.
2020	Solo exhibition New Moon, Artespacio, Santiago. Awarded the Chilean Art Critics Circle Prize.
2024	Solo exhibition Endurance, Artespacio, Santiago: Stone and Steel.
2026	Exhibition with Angela Leible, Imperial Oracle, Instituto Cultural de Lo Barnechea, El Tranque, Santiago.

IN ENGLAND

1978	Visual Art, British Council, Portland Place, London.
1979	St Martin's at Camden Institute, London; St Martin's at the Polytechnic of North London.
1982	Sculpture in the Garden, Woodstock, Oxford, United Kingdom.
1983	Tate Gallery, London: Have You Seen Sculpture from the Body, an exhibition resulting from a three-year research project by St Martin's postgraduate faculty and students associated with the New Generation of British Sculptors. Gazitua directed the wood section and presented his work. Curated by Alan Bowness, Director of the Tate Gallery.
1984	Have You Seen Sculpture from the Body, Woodlands Art Gallery, London.
1985	Have You Seen Sculpture from the Body, presented at Cartwright Hall, Bradford; Castle Howard, Yorkshire; and Robinson College, England.
2016	Group exhibition Forge, Ruthin Craft Centre, United Kingdom.

IN GERMANY

1992	Group exhibition Begegnung Mit Den Anderen, Kassel.
1992-1994	Group exhibition Abstrakte Stahlskulptur, presented at the Academy of Fine Arts, Berlin; Burgerfoyer des Sachsischen Landtags, Dresden; Kunsthalle Mannheim; Bochum Museum; Carl Orff Saal foyer, Munich; and the City Museum, Bad Hersfeld. Curated by Tim Scott and Robert Kudielka, Akademie der Künste, Berlin.
2022	Mokomiro Variations, Hampstead School of Art, London.
2025	Sculptures after Drawings by Tim Scott, Hampstead School of Art, London.

THE AMERICAS AND THE UNITED STATES

1994	Group exhibitions at Atelier Livre, Porto Alegre, Brazil; Resistencia-Chaco, Argentina; DeLind Fine Art Gallery, Milwaukee, Wisconsin; and Wood, Palacio Santa Maria, Alajuela, Costa Rica.
1995	Group exhibition The Strategy of Form, Museum of Contemporary Art (MARCO), Monterrey, Mexico, curated by Lina Zambrano and Lily Kassner.
2016	Solo exhibition Black and White, Galeria Enlace, Lima, Peru.
2018	Solo exhibition Cosmic Race, Instituto Cultural Cabanas, Guadalajara, Mexico, curated by the University of Guadalajara and Olga Ramirez Campusano.
2021	Mokomiro Variations, Hampstead School of Art, London.

AWARDS IN NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL COMPETITIONS

1986	First Prize, CAP Outdoor Sculpture Competition, Parque Forestal, Santiago, Chile.
1994	First Prize, La Tercera newspaper competition for a monumental sculpture at Santiago Airport, Chile.
1995	First Prize, International Ice Sculpture Symposium, Milwaukee, Wisconsin; First Prize, Stone Sculpture Competition, Las Tacas, Coquimbo Region, Chile.
1996	Award and commission for a monumental sculpture, Ciudad Empresarial, Santiago.
1997	First Prize, stone sculpture competition for the Radomiro Tomic Mine, Calama; First Prize, sculpture for the CCT Building, Santiago.
1998	First Prize, granite sculpture for the Ericsson Building, Santiago; First Prize, Cordillera de los Andes sculpture, Humlegarden, Stockholm, Sweden.
1999	First Prize, Fuente de los Jovenes project, granite, Plaza Pedro de Valdivia, Providencia, Santiago.
2003	First Prize, international competition for Barca Volante, CityPlace, Toronto, Canada.
2005	Award and commission for Piedra de cuatro miradas, Sculpture Bridge, Santiago; First Prize, international competition for Rosa Nautica, Concord CityPlace, Toronto; First Prize, international competition for Art Canopy, The Esplanade, Toronto; First Prize for design, international competition for Puente de Luz, with the participation of Santiago Calatrava, Toronto.
2010	First Prize, international competition for the Monarch sculptural ensemble, Toronto.
2011	First Prize, international competition for the Absolut Building sculptural ensemble, Mississauga, Canada, curated by MAD architects, Toronto.
2012	First Prize, international competition for Perpetual Motion, Liberty Village, Toronto; First Prize, Monument to Fray Francisco Valdes Subercaseaux, Pucon, Chile.
2013	First Prize, international competition for Split Rock Gap, Liberty Village, Toronto; First Prize and commission for Caballo de Lo Barnechea, Santiago.
2014	First Prize and commission for Arte de Pajaros, University of Chile, Santiago.

2015

First Prize and commission for Puertas de Chicureo, Colina, Santiago; First Prize, international competition for Black and Knight, Calgary, Canada.

2020

First Prize, competition commemorating 500 years since Magellan's voyage, Punta Arenas. The work was produced in the artist's Pirque studio, transported and assembled between August and October 2020 during the pandemic.

Further information: www.franciscogazitua.com